

Lo, how a Rose e'er blooming

Text: v.1-2 anonymous, 1599; v.3 Friedrich Layritz, 1599
tr. v.1-2 Theodore Baker, 1894; v.3 Harriet Spaeth, 1875; alt.
ES IST EIN ROS' 76.76.676

Music: Michael Praetorius, 1609

The musical score is written for a single voice part on a treble clef staff with a key signature of two flats (B-flat and E-flat). The melody is simple and hymn-like, with a final double bar line at the end of the fourth line. The lyrics are arranged in four lines, corresponding to the four staves of music. The first line of music has three verses of lyrics. The second line of music has two verses. The third line of music has two verses. The fourth line of music has two verses. The lyrics are as follows:

1 Lo, how a Rose e'er bloom - ing from ten - der stem has sprung!
2 I - sa - iah 'twas fore - told it, the Rose I have in mind.
3 Flow - er, whose fra-grance ten - der with sweet-ness fills the air,
Of Jes - se's lin - eage com - ing as saints of old have sung.
With Ma - ry we be - hold it, the vir - gin moth - er kind.
dis - pel in glo - rious splen - dor the dark-ness ev - 'ry-where.
It came a flow'r - et bright, a - mid the
To show God's love a - right, she bore to
Hu - man, yet ver - y God, from sin and
cold of win - ter, when half - spent was the night.
us a Sav - ior, when half - spent was the night.
death he saves us, and light - ens ev - 'ry load.